SUKASH CHANDRASHEKHAR



CLAIM TO INFAMY
Accused of extorting Rs 200 crore from the wife of a top industrialist from inside a high-security jail, and conning people of a total of Rs 500 crore in the past 15 years

NOTHING ABOUT HIS APPEARANCE INVITES YOU to cast a second glance at Sukash Chandrashekhar. Ordinary of build, average in height–5 feet, 9 inches–the 33-year-old looks a regular guy. When in school in Bengaluru, his friends teased him as *Karia*–the Kannada word for black–for his dark complexion. There is nothing flashy about his clothes either; he would mostly be found in denims with a tee. He has four fingers missing on his left hand. Nobody knows how he lost them–in an accident or if someone chopped them off. But you don't get to see the hand–he always keeps it hidden in his trouser pocket.

What you cannot miss, though, is his right hand, sporting some of the world's most expensive watches. Or the cars he drives—a fleet of top-end marques, among them Rolls Royce, Maserati, Lamborghini, Ferrari and Porsche. At last count, he had 85 watches worth Rs 18 crore and 54 cars worth more than Rs 35 crore in his possession. However, what makes this seemingly ordinary man extraordinary is the fact that he came to acquire these prized possessions allegedly by pulling some of the most elaborate cons in Indian history.

Going by unofficial accounts, he has reportedly defrauded nearly a thousand people of at least Rs 500 crore in the past 15 years. This calculation is derived from the more than 30 cases lodged against him in police stations in six states—Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Maharashtra and Delhi. His biggest heist came between

SMOOTH OPERATOR

Starting when he was 17, Sukash chose victims from all walks of life–from politicians, corporate honchos to even security guards. Though the ED in its chargesheet lists some 30 cases registered against him, he is yet to be convicted in any

2007, Bengaluru
Cheats a senior citizen after promising to resolve a land dispute with Bangalore Development Authority. Arrested with parents later
Rs 1.15 crore

2009, Bengaluru



Introduces himself as son of then Karnataka minister **G. Karunakara Reddy**. Takes money from victim promising to get him a car
Rs 3.72 lakh

2009, Bengaluru
Takes money from another victim saying he'll sell him a car
Rs 75,000

2009, Bengaluru
He and two others tell their target they'll get him a BMW, take money. Later threaten victim when he demands his money back
Rs 2 lakh

2010, Chennai
Pretends to be then Tamil Nadu CM M. Karunanidhi's grandson, takes money from victim promising to get him a car at government auction
Rs 2 lakh

2010, Chennai
Rents a three-bedroom apartment for Rs 50,000 a month. Does not pay. Also takes money from landlord saying he'll get him a Scorpio car at state auction
Rs 3.5 lakh

2010, Madurai
Takes advance payment from a cinema hall manager for installing a new digital sound system. Tries to strangle victim when confronted
21 watches, 2 cars bought using the money recovered

2009, Bengaluru
Hires a gunman as 'minister Karunakara Reddy's son', pays him only part of promised salary
Rs 20,000